

Sound as Story: Field Recording in Narrative Documentary

Helen Sexton

Senior Thesis, Tisch School of the Arts, NYU

Submitted May 2017

ABSTRACT

This thesis examines the use of ambient field recording as a storytelling device in long-form narrative documentary. Three case studies — Radio Diaries' 'Teen Diaries', Snap Judgment's 'Glory Hounds', and Radiolab's 'Black Box' — illustrate how spatial audio can carry information that voice-over cannot.

CHAPTER 1 — The Microphone as Camera

CHAPTER 2 — Silence, Room Tone, and the Edit

CHAPTER 3 — Three Case Studies

CHAPTER 4 — Toward a Working Vocabulary

(Full chapters and bibliography omitted from this PDF copy.

Original deposited with Tisch Cinema Studies, May 2017.)